



## WESUPPORTHER (WSH) VOLUNTEER POLICY

### 1. Introductory Statement

This Volunteer Policy ("**Policy**") establishes the framework governing the recruitment, engagement, management, supervision and conduct of volunteers serving with WeSupportHer ("**WSH**" or the "**Organisation**"). It sets out the standards, expectations, rights and responsibilities applicable to volunteers in support of WSH's mission to advance gender equity, promote the health and wellbeing of women and girls, strengthen women's leadership, and empower women and girls to realise their full potential.

The Policy is intended to promote a safe, respectful, accountable and professional volunteering environment that protects the interests of volunteers, beneficiaries, staff, partners and the Organisation, while ensuring that volunteer activities are undertaken in a manner consistent with WSH's values, policies and strategic objectives.

This Policy should be read together with the **WSH Volunteer Agreement**, which every volunteer is required to execute as a condition precedent to commencing any volunteer engagement with the Organisation. By signing the Volunteer Agreement and participating in any WSH activity, each volunteer acknowledges that they have read, understood and agree to comply with the provisions of this Policy and any other policies, procedures or codes of conduct that may be issued by the Organisation from time to time.

While this Policy seeks to address the principal matters relating to volunteer engagement, it is not intended to be exhaustive and cannot anticipate every circumstance that may arise in the course of volunteering. Accordingly, WSH reserves the right to interpret, review, amend, supplement or withdraw any provision of this Policy, in whole or in part, from time to time where necessary to reflect changes in applicable law, operational requirements, organisational priorities or recognised best practice. Any amendments shall be communicated to volunteers through appropriate channels, including email communications, internal memoranda or other official notices.

Compliance with this Policy is a mandatory condition of volunteering with WSH. Volunteers are expected to familiarise themselves with its provisions and to conduct themselves at all times in a manner that upholds the Organisation's mission, values, reputation and commitment to safeguarding those it serves.

### 2. About WeSupportHer

#### OUR VISION

A world where every woman and girl enjoys equal rights, opportunities, dignity and representation; and where gender equity is embedded in the policies, institutions and cultures that shape our societies

### **OUR MISSION**

To advance gender equity by promoting women and girl's health, amplifying their voices, supporting their leadership and increasing their participation in governance and decision-making through advocacy, education, partnerships and community-driven action

### **OUR CORE VALUES**

Accountability, Commitment, Community, Empathy, Partnership, Transparency (ACCEPT).

Volunteers are expected to uphold and demonstrate the core values of WeSupportHer throughout their engagement with the Organisation.

## **3. Definitions**

For the purpose of this Policy:

**"Beneficiary"** means any individual or community receiving support, services, training, advocacy, or assistance from WeSupportHer.

**"Confidential Information"** means any information relating to WeSupportHer, its beneficiaries, volunteers, staff, donors, partners, programmes, finances, operations, or other non-public information acquired through volunteer service, whether or not expressly marked as confidential.

**"Organisation"** means WeSupportHer.

**"Volunteer"** means an individual who freely contributes time, skills, knowledge, or expertise to support the activities of WeSupportHer without expectation of financial remuneration.

Volunteers are not employees and do not have an employment relationship with the Organisation. This Policy does not create, and shall not be construed to create, any contract of employment between WSH and any volunteer.

## **4. Scope**

This Policy applies to all individuals who volunteer with WeSupportHer, irrespective of the nature, duration, or location of their engagement. It applies to volunteers serving on a short-term, long-term, project-based, event-specific, virtual, remote, hybrid, or ad hoc basis, whether within or outside Nigeria, where such activities are undertaken on behalf of WeSupportHer.

## **5. Principles of Volunteer Engagement**

WSH is committed to ensuring that volunteer engagement is guided by the following principles:

- Respect and dignity for all volunteers, beneficiaries, staff and other stakeholders;
- Equal opportunity and non-discrimination;
- Transparency and accountability;
- Safeguarding of beneficiaries and volunteers;
- Meaningful participation;
- Safe and supportive working environments;
- Recognition and appreciation of volunteer contributions; and

- Alignment with the organization's mission, vision, and values.

## **6. Eligibility**

To become a volunteer, applicants must:

- Meet the minimum age requirement of 18 years, or have parental/guardian consent if below 18;
- Demonstrate an interest in gender equity and community development;
- Complete the prescribed application and onboarding process;
- Provide accurate and complete information throughout the application process;
- Provide references where requested;
- Possess the skills, experience, or willingness to learn necessary for assigned tasks; and
- Agree to comply with WSH's policies and procedures.

The Organisation reserves the right to accept or decline volunteer applications based on organisational needs.

## **7. Recruitment and Selection**

Volunteer recruitment and selection shall be conducted fairly, transparently, and without unlawful discrimination. Selection shall be based on organisational needs, suitability for the relevant role, and the volunteer's qualifications, experience, skills, or demonstrated willingness to learn. It shall include:

- Online applications.
- Referrals.
- Community outreach.
- Volunteer drives.
- Partnerships with schools, universities, and organisations.

## **8. Orientation**

All volunteers shall undergo a mandatory orientation programme before commencing volunteer activities. The orientation shall include but not limited to:

- Insights into WSH's mission, vision, and core values;
- the volunteer's roles and responsibilities;
- confidentiality requirements;
- data protection obligations;
- health and safety procedures;
- reporting and supervision arrangements; and
- applicable organisational policies and procedures.

## **9. Volunteer Responsibilities**

Volunteers are expected to:

- Act professionally and respectfully;
- Uphold the reputation of WSH;
- Perform assigned duties diligently and responsibly;
- Maintain confidentiality of sensitive information;

- Comply with this Policy and other applicable organisational policies;
- Report safeguarding concerns promptly;
- Protect organisational property and resources;
- Disclose any actual or potential conflict of interest;
- Comply with applicable data protection requirements;
- Respect beneficiaries, staff, partners, and fellow volunteers; and
- Communicate availability and limitations honestly.

## **10. Rights of Volunteers**

Volunteers have the right to:

- Be treated with respect and dignity.
- Receive adequate orientation and support.
- Work in a safe environment.
- Receive clear role descriptions.
- Be protected from discrimination, harassment, and abuse.
- Receive recognition for their contributions.
- Raise concerns without fear of retaliation.

## **11. Confidential Information**

Volunteers may, in the course of their engagement, have access to confidential information relating to WSH, its beneficiaries, volunteers, staff, donors, partners, programmes, organisational operations or other non-public information.

Such information shall be treated as strictly confidential and shall not be disclosed, copied, reproduced, retained, or used for any purpose other than the authorised performance of volunteer duties as approved by WSH. This obligation shall continue after the volunteer's engagement has ended for a period of two (2) years.

Upon cessation of volunteer service, volunteers shall promptly return, delete, or securely destroy all confidential documents, records, materials, equipment, and other organisational property in their possession.

## **12. Organisational Property**

Volunteers shall use organisational equipment, documents, branding, systems, and other resources solely for authorised purposes connected with their volunteer roles.

Volunteers shall exercise reasonable care in the use of organisational property and shall immediately report any loss, damage, or unauthorised use.

Upon termination of volunteer service, volunteers shall immediately return all organisational property in their possession, including identity cards, access credentials, documents, electronic devices, and other materials belonging to WSH.

### **13. Harrasment**

WSH is committed to protecting the safety, dignity, and well-being of its beneficiaries, staff, and volunteers. WSH operates a zero-tolerance approach to harassment, abuse, or exploitation of any kind, including sexual harassment, whether occurring during volunteer activities or at related events.

Volunteers shall not engage in unsupervised one-to-one interactions with minor beneficiaries and other stakeholders of the Organisation except where expressly authorised by WSH.

Harassment includes any unwelcome physical, verbal, or non-verbal conduct of a sexual or discriminatory nature which makes a person feel uncomfortable, offended, humiliated, or intimidated. This includes, without limitation, unwanted physical contact, sexually suggestive comments or gestures, and unwanted advances, whether directed at beneficiaries, staff, or fellow volunteers.

Any volunteer who experiences or witnesses harassment, abuse, exploitation, or a concern should report it to the Director, Programs & Communications ([tolu.abdul@wesupporther.org](mailto:tolu.abdul@wesupporther.org)) as soon as possible. Reports will be treated confidentially and investigated promptly. Volunteers will not face retaliation for reporting in good faith.

Confirmed violations of this section will result in immediate termination of volunteer engagement. Where the conduct may constitute a criminal offence, WSH reserves the right to report the matter to law enforcement authorities.

### **14. Conflict of Interest**

Volunteers shall avoid any actual, potential, or perceived conflict between their personal interests and the interests of WSH.

Any such conflict shall be disclosed promptly to the relevant programme coordinator. WSH may determine and implement appropriate measures to manage or eliminate the conflict.

### **15. Code of Conduct**

The following conducts are strictly prohibited and may result in disciplinary action, including immediate termination of volunteer engagement:

- Harassment or bullying.
- Sexual misconduct.
- Abuse of authority.
- Fraud or theft.
- Misrepresentation of the Organisation.
- Sharing Confidential Information without authorisation

### **16. Social Media and Public Communication**

Volunteers may not speak on behalf of WSH without authorisation.

Photographs, videos, beneficiary stories, and organisational information may only be shared in accordance with approved communication guidelines and consent, as further set out in the Volunteer Agreement Form.

## **17. Volunteer Expenses**

Volunteers are generally not entitled to financial compensation. However, approved expenses incurred while carrying out authorised volunteer activities may be reimbursed subject to prior written approval, submission of appropriate supporting documentation (where applicable).

## **18. Termination of Volunteer Engagement**

Volunteer engagement may be terminated:

- Upon completion of the volunteer assignment;
- At the volunteer's request;
- For misconduct or policy violations;
- Where continued engagement is no longer in the Organisation's best interest.

Save in cases of gross misconduct or immediate risk to beneficiaries or staff, in which case termination may be immediate and without notice, WSH will endeavour to provide reasonable notice before terminating a volunteer's engagement.

## **19. Data Protection**

WSH collects, stores and processes personal data from volunteers, including contact details, date of birth, and photographic or video content, for the purposes of volunteer administration, promotional and reporting activities. This data is processed in accordance with the Nigeria Data Protection Act 2023. Volunteers may withdraw consent to the use of their image or likeness at any time by notifying the relevant programme coordinator, though withdrawal will not affect the lawfulness of any use prior to withdrawal.

## **20. Intellectual Property**

Any reports, training materials, research, presentations, photographs, videos, graphics, publications, designs, databases, or other work products created by a volunteer in the course of, or arising from, volunteer activities for WSH shall belong exclusively to WSH, unless otherwise agreed in writing.

## **21. Review of Policy**

This Policy shall be reviewed periodically to ensure that it remains consistent with applicable laws, organisational needs, and recognised best practices. WSH reserves the right to amend this Policy from time to time and shall notify volunteers of any material amendments.



## **22. Declaration**

All volunteers are required to read, understand, and agree to abide by this Volunteer Policy as a condition precedent for their engagement with WeSupportHer. Acceptance of this Policy is confirmed by the volunteer's execution of the WSH Volunteer Agreement Form.

By volunteering with WeSupportHer, individuals commit to upholding the mission, values, and standards of the organisation while contributing positively to the advancement of gender equity and the empowerment of women and girls.

**JULY 2026**